

Environmental Impact Assessment on Temukhi Point and Surrounding Areas

Abstract

This study presents an Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) for Temukhi Point and its adjacent areas under Sylhet City Corporation. The primary objective was to evaluate environmental conditions, identify pollution sources, and propose mitigation strategies. The assessment involved surveying nine diverse locations (including construction, markets, residential areas, and factories) through direct observation, stakeholder interviews, and secondary data analysis. Findings revealed critical environmental issues, notably high accumulation of solid and plastic waste, along with significant air, noise, and water pollution, compounded by the blockage of natural waterways. These problems stem mainly from improper waste disposal and low community awareness. The study recommends an integrated Environmental Management Plan (EMP), focusing on integrated waste management, wastewater treatment, emission control, and heightened public awareness and community engagement, to ensure regulatory compliance and promote sustainable urban ecological balance.

Keywords: Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA), Temukhi Point, Pollution, Waste Management, Water Pollution, Air Pollution, Noise Pollution, Environmental Management Plan (EMP).

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Executive Summary

This executive summary provides a concise overview of the Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) conducted for Temukhi Point and its surrounding areas within the Sylhet City Corporation. The primary objective of this assessment was to evaluate the potential environmental impacts associated with various infrastructures in the area and propose effective mitigation measures.

The EIA report examined nine specific locations, including a construction site, community center, fish market, residential houses, school and surroundings, bazaar, ghat, bridge, and factory. Through on-site observations, data collection, and interviews with residents and stakeholders, the report identified several negative environmental impacts in the area.

The major environmental concerns identified include waste pollution (particularly plastic waste), air pollution (related to construction activities), sound pollution, water pollution, and water blockage. These impacts have been attributed to improper waste disposal practices, lack of designated waste disposal facilities, and inadequate awareness among the community.

To mitigate these impacts, the report proposes a comprehensive set of measures. These include implementing proper waste management practices, promoting the use of eco-friendly alternatives to plastic, adopting emission control measures for industries and vehicles, establishing wastewater treatment systems, and conducting regular cleaning and maintenance of waterways.

The report emphasizes the importance of community awareness and engagement in achieving the proposed mitigation measures. It also underscores the need for effective implementation and monitoring to ensure the long-term success of these measures.

The Environmental Management Plan (EMP) presented in the report outlines the timeline, responsibilities, and follow-up actions for implementing the proposed mitigation measures. It aims to minimize disruptions to the local ecosystem, adhere to environmental regulations, and promote sustainable development practices.

It is important to note that the report has certain limitations, including potential biases in onsite data collection, limited depth and comprehensiveness due to time constraints, and the need for proper implementation of identified measures beyond the scope of the EIA.

By addressing the identified environmental concerns and implementing the proposed mitigation measures, the EIA report aims to contribute to sustainable development and responsible environmental practices in Temukhi Point and its surrounding areas. The findings and recommendations serve as valuable inputs for decision-making processes and lay the foundation for effective environmental management in the region.

Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background

The study area for this Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) report is Temukhi Point and its surrounding areas, which holds significant importance within the Sylhet City Corporation. Temukhi Point is widely recognized for its diverse and bustling nature, making it a key socio-economic hub in Sylhet Sadar. This location encompasses a range of establishments, including residential buildings, shops, workshops, factories, bus stands, and educational institutions. Given the prominence and variety of infrastructures present in this area, it becomes crucial to assess its environmental condition and evaluate the impact of different structures on the surrounding environment.

The primary objective of this EIA is to assess the potential environmental impacts associated with the activities occurring in these diverse locations. To ensure a comprehensive evaluation, nine specific locations with varying infrastructural significance have been selected for analysis. These locations encompass a construction site, a community center, a fish market, residential houses, a school and its surroundings, a bazaar, a ghat, a bridge, and a factory.

The assessment of the environmental impacts is essential to understand the current state of the environment in the study area and to identify any potential adverse effects arising from the activities taking place in these locations. Through this EIA, the goal is to provide a thorough evaluation of the environmental consequences and propose suitable mitigation measures to minimize any negative impacts.

By conducting this assessment, we aim to ensure sustainable development and promote responsible environmental practices in Temukhi Point and its surrounding areas. The findings and recommendations of this EIA will contribute to informed decision-making processes, facilitating the implementation of environmentally sound practices and minimizing any harm caused to the ecosystem.

It is imperative to consider the intricate relationship between the diverse infrastructures and the surrounding environment in order to strike a balance between development and environmental preservation. This EIA report will provide a comprehensive analysis of the potential environmental impacts associated with the activities in these locations, setting the foundation for effective environmental management and sustainable development practices.

1.2 Project Introduction

Our selected location was Temukhi point and its adjacent areas.

Temukhi Point Coordinates:

Latitude: 24° 54' 43.6212" N

Longitude: 91° 48' 30.7872" E

9 stations were selected for surveying.

Table 1: Station Number and their Identification

Stations	Station Names
1	Building Construction Site
2	Community Center
3	Temukhi Toker bazar Fish Market
4	Haydarpur Houses
5	Hazi Abdis Sattar High School and Surroundings
6	Toker Bazar Market
7	Toker Bazar Ghat and Bridge
8	Temukhi Bridge
9	Icebar Factory

1.3 Need of Study

The aim of this study is to assess the environmental consequences associated with the selected sites. Infrastructure development often occurs without prior assessment of its environmental impact, making it crucial to identify and evaluate potential adverse effects on the environment caused by any project.

Conducting an Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) is not only a legal requirement but also an essential step in obtaining regulatory approvals for proposed activities. This study aims to ensure compliance with environmental regulations and guidelines.

On-site visits will facilitate a better understanding of the issues at hand, and conducting surveys will provide essential information to support decision-making processes. The assessment will enable informed decision-making by identifying and analyzing potential environmental risks and impacts of the proposed activities. Moreover, involving residents and stakeholders in this process will take their input and concerns into consideration and contribute to effective decision-making.

1.4 Period of Study

Date: 10. June. 2023

Duration: 3.00-5.00 PM

It was a 1-day field trip for conducting the survey. It was a 2 long hour survey, and all the 9 locations were visited within this period. The time of visit is given below:

Table 2: Visit time of each Station

Stations	Station Names	Field-visit Time (Bangladesh Standard Time)
1	Building Construction Site	3.15 PM
2	Community Center	3.27 PM
3	Temukhi Toker bazar Fish Market	3.45 PM
4	Haydarpur Houses	3.53 PM
5	Hazi Abdis Sattar High School and Surroundings	4.00 PM
6	Toker Bazar Market	4.10 PM
7	Toker Bazar Ghat and Bridge	4.15 PM
8	Temukhi Bridge	4.37 PM
9	Icebar Factory	4.50 M

1.5 EIA Methodology Approach

The methodology for this EIA report is based on the 'EIA Guidelines for Industries' published by the Department of Environment, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of the People's Republic of Bangladesh in February 2021. The purpose of this study was to understand the types and amount of pollution caused by the selected infrastructures. initial data was collected by physically examining the sites and their surrounding areas, conducting interviews with the residents and stakeholders using questionnaires.

The key activities conducted during the assessment included:

- (i) Engage in ongoing conversations (figure1,2) with community members and various sources to gather insights about the infrastructures and the associated pollution they generate.
- (ii) Conduct on-site observations (figure 3) of the locations and their surrounding areas to identify the types of pollution they generate and observe their waste disposal practices.

- (iii) Systematically record and document the information obtained during the assessment.
- (iv) Construct map (figure 4) of study location
- (v) Examine and analyze available reports related to these sites.
- (vi) Acquire environmental data from satellite sources to supplement the assessment.
- (vii) Analysis the alternatives
- (viii) Assessing the impacts and identifying measures to eliminate or minimize them through mitigation.



Figure 1: Conversation with the residents



Figure 2: Conversation with local stakeholders



Figure 3: On-site Observation during Survey



Figure 4: Map Constructing Tool

1.6 Limitations

The present study was based on primary field investigations and secondary data collection from satellite-based sources. The on-site collected data can be biased and can affect the accuracy and reliability of the report. As the survey was conducted within specific timeframe, it can limit the depth and comprehensiveness of the assessment. Working in a particular time-limit may cause

uncertainty in the result of the report. Again, effectiveness of the identified mitigation measures depends on the proper implementation. As the EIA reports may not have control over the actual implementation process, it can potentially impact the overall success of mitigating identified impacts. In the case of long-term monitoring, evaluating the long-term impact may be limited, which can make it challenging to assess the accuracy of the initial predictions and effectiveness of the mitigation measures.

Chapter 2: Terms of Reference

- i. Collection of relevant information useful for the project ii.
To assess the designated locations
- iii. To assess the impact of the report over the local community and the nation in general
- iv. To assess and report the potential negative impact of the surveyed areas v.
Develop an environment management plan vi. Develop necessary
measures for mitigation

Chapter 3: Project Description

3.1 Site Location

Location: Temukhi Point and its surrounding areas

Union: Toker Bazar (6 No)

Upazilla: Sylhet Sadar

District: Sylhet

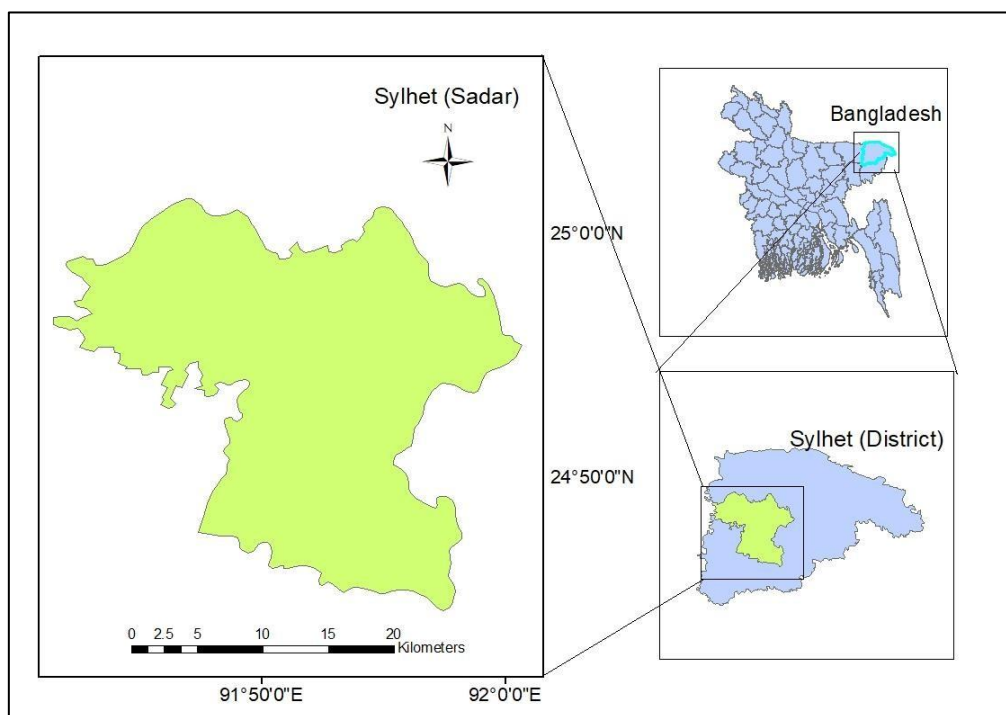


Figure 5: Sylhet Sadar

Temukhi Point Coordinates:

Latitude: 24° 54' 43.6212" N

Longitude: 91° 48' 30.7872" E

As our given location was Temukhi Point and surrounding areas we selected 1 km South from Temukhi point (Latitude: 24° 54' 45.7128" N, Longitude: 91° 48' 30.7872" E).

500-meter area in both East and West of this length was taken as our study area (figure 2).

We picked 9 sites of great commercial and social importance for our assessment.

The sites with their locations are given in Table 1.

Table 3: Surveyed Stations with their coordinates

Stations	Station Names	Latitude	Longitude
1	Building Construction Site	24.9135614366718	91.8228777263174
2	Community Center	24.9143353397877	91.8214065398104
3	Temukhi Toker bazar Fish Market	24.9146711567612	91.8202466974817
4	Haydarpur houses	24.9145088170618	91.8199277920278
5	Hazi Abdis Sattar High School and Surroundings	24.9145055042930	91.8198120294777
6	Toker Bazar Market	24.9136948212152	91.8141801348267
7	Toker Bazar Ghat and Bridge	24.9129369090847	91.8132626689597
8	Temukhi Bridge	24.9105570944583	91.8237411344794
9	Icebar Factory	24.9091348887243	91.8215878511029

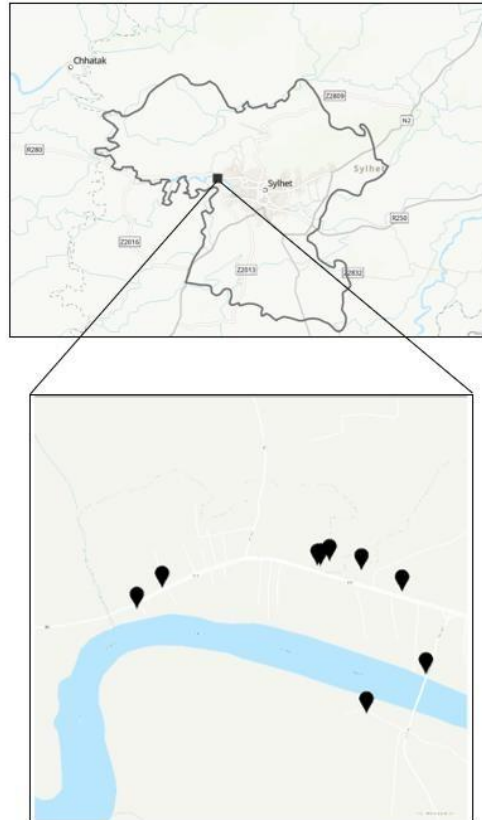


Figure 6: Surveyed Stations

3.2 Site Status

Our assigned locations Temukhi Point, and its surrounding areas are under the 6 no union at Sylhet Sadar Upazilla. It is situated on the Sylhet-Sunamganj Highway. The area around Temukhi Point is home to various institutions and amenities. It includes Kumargon Bus Stand and the nearby Shahjalal University of Science and Technology. Additionally, the area features workshops, residential buildings, schools, shops, restaurants, and other establishments.

3.3 Site Ownership

some locations were personal possessions, and some were States owned and public assets. Their ownership status is given below:

Table 4: Station Ownership Status

Stations	Station Names	Ownership
1	Building Construction Site	Private
2	Community Center	Private (Commercial Space)
3	Temukhi Toker bazar Fish Market	Toker Bazar Fish Retailers Cooperative Society Ltd
4	Haydarpur Houses	Private
5	Hazi Abdis Sattar High School and Surroundings	Governmental and Private
6	Toker Bazar Market	Governmental (Sylhet City Corporation)
7	Toker Bazar Ghat and Bridge	Governmental (Sylhet City Corporation)
8	Temukhi Bridge	Governmental (Sylhet City Corporation)
9	Icebar Factory	Private (Industrial Space)

Chapter 4: Legislative, Regulation and Policy Consideration

Various laws and regulation for protection and conservation of natural environment has been established by Bangladesh Government. The laws applicable to this project are given below:

Table 5: The applied laws and their requirements

Name	Key Requirements
Environment Court Act, 2000 and subsequent amendments in 2000	To give high priority to environment pollution prevention
The Private Forests Ordinance Act, 1959	Conservation of private forests and for the afforestation on wastelands.
Water Pollution Control	Prevention of water pollution
Water Supply and Sanitation Act, 1996	Management and Control of water supply and sanitation in urban areas.
Natural Water Bodies Protection Act 2000	the character of water bodies i.e. rivers, canals, tanks, or floodplains identified as water bodies in the master plans or in the master plans formulated under the laws establishing municipalities in division and district towns shall not be changed without approval of concerned ministry.
National Environment Policy, 1992	For sustainable development

The National Water Management Plan, 2001	Addresses options for water quality, considerations behind measures to clean up industrial pollution, where effluent discharge monitoring and zoning regulations for new industries are emphasized
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Chapter 5: Baseline Conditions

5.1 Environmental Setting

The site details have already been discussed under Chapter 3. The environmental components are discussed further in this chapter.

Table 6: Environmental Setting

Location	Temukhi Point Sylhet-Sunamganj Highway Latitude: 24° 54' 43.6212" N Longitude: 91° 48' 30.7872" E
Site Elevation	50 feet (average)
Seismic Zone	Zone 1
Forest / National Parks	None within 5km zone
Archaeologically important places / Monuments	None within 5km zone

5.2 Meteorology

The Project area lies within the North-Eastern climate zone of the country. It shows tropical monsoon climate with three prominent seasons: 1. Summer – pre-monsoon – March-May, Rainy season (monsoon) - June to October; and winter season - November to February.

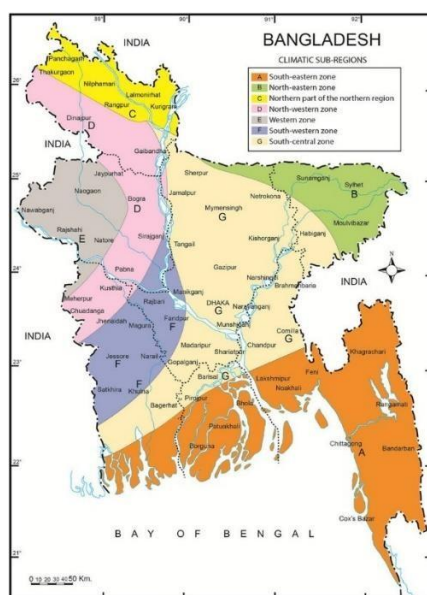


Figure 7: Climate Zones of Bangladesh

Analysis of meteorological parameters are given below:

Table 7: Meteorological Parameters

Parameters	Values
Annual High Temperature	31.46°C (88.63°F)
Annual low temperature	20.78°C (69.4°F)
Average annual precipitation	158.65mm (6.25in)
Humidity	67.88%
Number of days with Rainfall (≥ 1.0 mm)	160.46 days (43.96%)

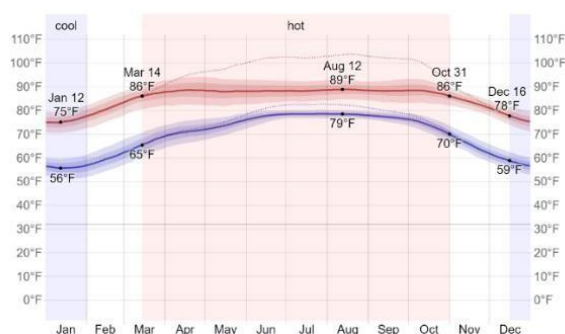


Figure 8: Average High and Low Temperature in Sylhet

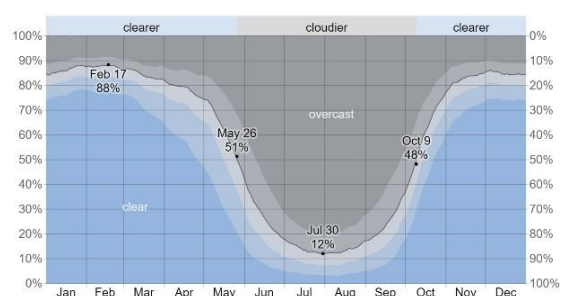


Figure 9: Cloud Cover Categories in Sylhet

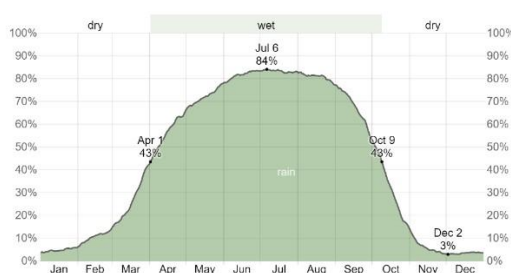


Figure 10: Daily Chance of Precipitation in Sylhet



Figure 11: Humidity Comfort Levels in Sylhet

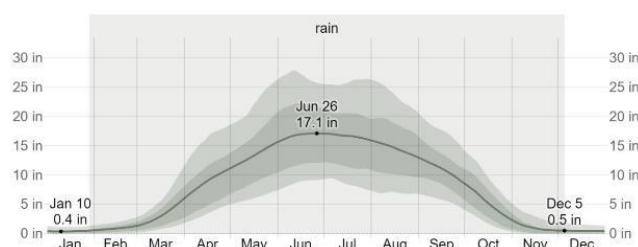


Figure 12: Average Monthly Rainfall in Sylhet

Chapter 6: Environmental Impact Assessment

6.1 Station 1

Building Construction Site



The operation of large equipment and construction activities resulted in both noise and air pollution. Additionally, the leftover waste materials from the construction were improperly disposed of on the streets, contributing to the accumulation of garbage.

6.2 Station 2

Community Center



The community center, being privately owned, serves as a venue for various events and gatherings. However, due to the absence of a designated waste disposal facility near the infrastructure, trash is discarded into the nearby pond. As a result, the water in the pond has become contaminated and polluted.

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.3 Station 3

Temukhi Tucker Bazar Fish Market



The fish market exhibited the presence of fish remnants, with no evident waste disposal infrastructure in place. Consequently, an unpleasant odor permeated the area, attracting numerous flies, thus posing unhygienic conditions. Furthermore, there were many food places beside the market and the food their seemed to be in high contamination risk.

6.4 Station 4

Houses in Haydarpur



As per a Haydarpur resident, the local community in the area has been disposing their waste in a pond adjacent to their houses. Consequently, this once-usable pond has become heavily polluted over the past few years. The presence of decaying household waste has emitted a foul odour, rendering the surroundings unpleasant. We also observed sound pollution from a nearby voting campaign.

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.5 Station 5

Hazi Abdis Sattar High School and Surroundings



The waste generated by the school and nearby shops is being indiscriminately discarded in the open space, particularly the canal adjacent to them. According to a local shop owner, this canal was once connected to the Surma River. However, due to irregular waste collection by the city corporation's waste disposal truck and the lack of awareness among the residents, the water body is becoming increasingly polluted and is effectively becoming a stagnant, non-functional waterway.

6.6 Station 6

Tuker Bazar Market



Tuker Bazar market is a vital hub that offers a wide range of essential daily items. However, despite its significance, there is a lack of proper waste disposal infrastructure in place. The majority of the waste generated in the market is biodegradable, but even so, it emits a foul odor, and garbage is scattered throughout the market. Additionally, the presence of numerous food

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carts poses a risk of food contamination due to the presence of flies attracted to the garbage. Majority of the waste is thrown in the Surma River.

.7 Station 7

Tuker Bazar Ghat and Bridge



On a daily basis, a significant number of individuals utilize the Ghat and the bridge for their commuting needs. Unfortunately, they tend to discard their trash in the surrounding areas. Additionally, the local shops contribute to the problem by disposing of their waste along the riverside, leading to an accumulation of garbage in the Ghat and beneath the bridge. Consequently, the small tributaries are becoming obstructed and filled with debris. Regrettably, no waste disposal facilities were observed in the vicinity.

6.8 Station 8

Temukhi Bridge



The Temukhi Bridge exhibited a relatively lower amount of litter compared to the Tuker Bazar Bridge. However, there were still numerous plastic bags, packets, and water bottles scattered

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around. The predominant type of trash found in this area was non-biodegradable in nature. It appeared to be individual waste rather than large-scale or collective disposal.

.9 Station 9

Icebar Factory



The sole factory included in the survey is an ice cream factory, operating as a local business. The primary waste generated by the factory consists of plastic ice cream packets and food chemicals. According to the workers, there is a lack of designated waste disposal facilities, and the city corporation's garbage trucks do not service the area. Consequently, the factory disposes of its waste by discarding it in the nearest water body, which happens to be located near the Temukhi Bridge.

The following types of negative environmental impacts were found in the surveyed locations:

- A. Waste Pollution, mainly plastic
- B. Air Pollution (Construction dust and rotten product odour)
- C. Sound Pollution
- D. Water Pollution
- E. River congestion

Out of all these waste pollution and water pollution and waterway blockage was the most prominent ones.

7. Mitigation

7.1 Waste pollution

7.1.1 Biodegradable Solid Waste

- i. Implement proper waste management practices, such as segregation, recycling, and composting.
- ii. Encourage and educate the community on the importance of reducing, reusing, and recycling waste.
- iii. Establish waste disposal facilities and encourage responsible waste disposal.

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7.1.2 Plastic Pollution

- i. Promote the use of eco-friendly alternatives to plastic materials.
- ii. Implement plastic waste management strategies, such as recycling and proper disposal.
- iii. Raise awareness about the negative impacts of plastic pollution and encourage behavioral changes.

7.2 Air Pollution

- i. Encourage the use of cleaner energy sources and technologies, such as renewable energy and electric vehicles.
- ii. Implement emission control measures for industrial activities and vehicles. iii. Promote green spaces and urban vegetation to help reduce air pollution.

7.3 Noise Pollution

- i. Implement noise control measures, such as using noise barriers and soundproofing materials.
- ii. Enforce regulations and guidelines for noise levels in residential, commercial, and industrial areas.
- iii. Promote public awareness about the harmful effects of noise pollution and encourage responsible behavior.

7.4 Water Pollution

- i. Implement proper wastewater treatment systems for industrial and domestic sources.
- ii. Enforce regulations on the discharge of pollutants into water bodies. iii. Promote sustainable agricultural practices to reduce the use of harmful chemicals and prevent runoff into water sources.

7.5 Water Blockage

- i. Implement regular cleaning and maintenance of waterways to prevent blockages. ii. Establish proper waste disposal systems to prevent the accumulation of debris in water bodies.
- iii. Conduct awareness campaigns to educate the community about the importance of keeping waterways clean and free from blockages.

Chapter 8: Environment Management Plan and Post Monitoring Action

The Environmental Management Plan (EMP) consolidates all proposed measures for mitigating and monitoring environmental impacts. It establishes a timeline, assigns responsibilities, and outlines follow-up actions. The EMP serves as a comprehensive action plan for avoiding, minimizing, and managing the adverse effects of the project.

The plan considers the following:

- The predicted Environmental Impact
- Proposed Measures for Mitigation
- Responsible Parties

The EMP is designed keeping in view the regulatory and other requirements to ensure the following: • Minimizing disruption to the indigenous plant and animal species.

- Ensuring adherence to regulations regarding air, water, soil, and noise pollution.
- Reduce water blockage to ensure natural water flow along the area

Table 8: Environmental Management Plan

Environmental Impact	Mitigation Measures	Responsible Parties
Biodegradable Solid Waste	Waste Management Practice	Local municipalities
	Waste Reduction Awareness	Community organizations and educational institutions
Plastic Pollution	Plastic Waste Management	Responsible Government regulatory bodies
	Disposal and Recycling	Recycling facilities and waste management companies
	Promoting Awareness	Involved Environmental organizations and community groups
Air Pollution	Emission Control measures	Responsible Industrial companies and factories
	Monitoring and enforcing air quality regulations	Government agencies and environmental authorities
	Promoting Sustainable Construction Methods	Urban planning and development authorities
Noise Pollution	Noise control measures in residential, commercial, and industrial areas.	Urban planning authorities and local municipalities
	Setting noise level guidelines and enforcing noise pollution regulation	Responsible Regulatory bodies
	Promoting public awareness and responsible behavior	Community organizations and advocacy groups
Water Pollution	Implementing wastewater treatment systems	Industrial facilities and businesses

	Enforcing water pollution regulations and monitoring water quality	Government agencies and environmental authorities
Water Blockage	Cleaning and maintaining waterways	Local municipalities and government authorities
	Proper waste disposal systems and preventing debris accumulation	Waste management agencies
	conducting awareness campaigns on waterway cleanliness	Environmental organizations and community groups

Chapter 9: Analysis of Alternatives

The following alternatives can be considered on the basis of the EIA assessment:

1. **Site Alternative:** The infrastructures having higher negative environmental impacts can be moved to another location.
2. **Design Alternatives:** Exploring alternative design options that minimize environmental impacts, such as ensuring a waste disposal location in the design.
3. **Construction Techniques:** Exploring alternative construction methods that minimize disruption to the environment and local communities.

Chapter 10: Conclusion and Recommendations

The Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) conducted in Temukhi Point and its surrounding areas highlighted the significant environmental challenges posed by various infrastructures. The assessment revealed waste pollution, air pollution, noise pollution, water pollution, and waterway blockage as the most prominent negative impacts. These findings emphasize the need for immediate action to mitigate these environmental issues and promote sustainable development practices.

The EIA report has provided a comprehensive analysis of the current environmental condition in the study area, identifying the sources and types of pollution generated by different infrastructures. It has also proposed suitable mitigation measures to minimize the negative impacts and ensure sustainable development. By implementing the recommendations outlined in the report, we can strive towards striking a balance between development and environmental preservation.

Recommendations:

- It is crucial to adhere to the rules and regulations to prevent such situations, and individuals should also comply.
- Effective dissemination of awareness is necessary.

References

List of secondary data used for the EIA study and preparation of EIA report is given in the following table.

Serial	Reference
Existing Studies	
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